



“People are tired of the 'perfect' airbrushed skin on billboards. They want to see how a foundation sits on textured Indian skin in 35°C heat”

SUNGJE MLILA LONGKUMER
CERTIFIED COSMETOLOGIST



“The industry is now open to a wider range of... skin tones, hair textures and everyone brings their own version of what worked for them”

RIDA THARANA
BEAUTY AND LIFESTYLE CONTENT CREATOR

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fragrances and derma skincare are witnessing strong traction.

BEAUTY WITHOUT GENDER

One of the most significant cultural shifts is the rapid growth of male grooming and gender-fluid cosmetics. Gen Z consumers see beauty as self-care rather than vanity - and certainly not as gendered behaviour.

Men are openly engaging with skincare, hair care and even makeup, driven by content that frames beauty as confidence, wellness and self-expression. Products are being designed without rigid gender cues, focusing instead on function, texture and results.

Male skincare is becoming increasingly mainstream. As per Kantar Insights, ‘sunscreen for men’ saw 61K searches with +59% growth, while branded kits like Hair Fact Kit Male grew +32%.

At the same time, male-specific nutraceuticals like gummies are declining (-34%), suggesting a shift toward functional, result-backed products. From grooming towards preventive skincare and wellness, by aligning with luxury trends, male beauty market is moving to become mainstream.”

HYPER-PERSONALISED, HYPER-EXPRESSIVE

What ties these trends together is a deeper shift in the consumer mindset. Beauty is no longer about just following trends; it has become more personalised based on skin type, climate, lifestyle and values.

Algorithms, quizzes, artificial intelligence (AI)-led recommendations, and community feedback loops are shaping routines that feel uniquely individual. In a crowded digital world, beauty has become a language of self-expression. “Personally, I’ve built

a skincare routine that’s very ingredient focused. Earlier, things like fragrance or how a product smelled mattered, but now people are far more conscious about what goes into a product and how it affects their skin,” says Tharana.

More people today are re-searching, experimenting, and forming their own opinions instead of following trends blindly.

“India’s Gen Z beauty consumer today is smart and curious... they are open to trying what’s trending, but confident enough to trust their own experience, form opinions, and stick with what actually works for them rather than blindly following the herd,” adds Tharana.

LOOKING BACK AT TRENDS

Nykaa’s Beauty Rewind 2025 report, released in the last week of December 2025, indicates that beauty in 2025 wasn’t about chasing what’s next; it was about building routines that last.

“Beauty in 2025 wasn’t about chasing what’s next; it was about moving fast, choosing smart, and switching without guilt. Indian consumers explored freely, followed trends unapologetically, and built routines that evolved with them,” it said. From barrier-first skincare to intelligent makeup, indulgent body care and mood-led fragrances, beauty became deeply personal and joyfully flexible.

India’s beauty boom is not being driven by glamour alone. It is powered by creators, data, regional voices, and a generation comfortable with questioning norms. In this new economy, beauty is not about perfection. It is about identity. **BT**

@sakshibatra18